

The UK Linguistics Olympiad 2019

Round 2



Solution and marking.

Scoring (max 29)

- **Q.1.1:** 1 for each correct answer, no half marks. (max 10)
- **Q.1.2:** 1 for each correct choice (a/b/c) (max 9)
 - 2 for each correct explanation, 1 with a single error.
- **Q.1.3:** 2 for each topic (listed below) covered correctly; 1 with one error. (max 10)

Q.1.1 a. afimadi	b. presidents	c. imeli
d. ature	e. baker	f. omukazisini
g. olengindi	h. language	i. isabatu
j. omukama		

Q.1.2.	(a), (b) or (c)?	explanation (ask for extra paper if necessary)
1. imulenzi	(b) boys	plural form with first and last vowels the same.
2. achosino	(a) school of fish	-sinV infix, as in <i>amelisini</i> vs <i>ameli</i> , <i>aturesine</i> vs <i>ature</i>
3. ukamamba	(c) banker	-ma- infix meaning 'professional X-er', as in baker, shoe-maker and farmer

Q.3. Describe what you have learned about the morphological structure of words in Afrihili.

A. Inflectional morphology:

- Plural formation: Final vowel replaces initial vowel of singular form.

B. Derivational morphology:

- Head of an organization: Final and initial vowel of root noun are reversed.
- Nouns of profession: Infix *-ma-* is inserted in penultimate position.
- Collective noun: Suffix *-sin-*+final vowel of root noun.
- Diminutive noun: Suffix *-nd-*+final vowel of root noun.

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Commentary

The following suffixes, infixes and alterations change the meaning of a word in Afrihili, where X is the original noun or its meaning:

- Final vowel replaces initial vowel → plural
- Final vowel and initial vowel are reversed → head of organization X
- Infix **-ma-** before final syllable → person who works with X
- Suffix **-le** or **-li** (depending on the preceding vowel) → place where X can be found
- Infix **-sin-** followed by replication of preceding vowel → a group of X

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Solution and marking.

Scoring (max 30)

- Q.2.1: 1 point for each correct letter (max 18)
- Q.2.2: 2 points for each correct Lepcha word; 1 point with one error (max 6)
- Q.2.3: 2 points for each correct transliteration; 1 with one error (max 6)

Q.2.1	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15	16	17	18
	J	F	A	Q	C	R	D	N	H	M	G	I	B	O	K	L	E	P
Q.2.2	chóng 'hand'																	
	jik 'native land'																	
	thikúng 'great-grandfather'						 (thi-kung) or  (thik-ung)											
Q.2.3	 'to crack'						dan											
	 'to read'						rok											
	 'elephant'						ranmo											

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Commentary

1. Writing direction is left to right.
2. The writing system is of a type called 'abjad', in which the main characters stand only for consonants, and vowels are either not shown at all or are shown by extra marks ('diacritics').
3. Syllable-initial consonants are written with full letters:

𐌀 *k*-, 𐌁 *kh*-, 𐌂 *ch*-, 𐌃 *t*-, 𐌄 *th*-, 𐌅 *d*-, 𐌆 *b*-, 𐌇 *ts*-, 𐌈 *r*-, 𐌉 *l*-

If there is no initial consonant, the null initial 𐌀 is used instead.

4. Vowels are marked by symbols to the left of, below, or to the right of consonants:

𐌀𐌁 *ke*, 𐌀𐌁𐌃 *ki*, (𐌀𐌁𐌆 *ko*, (𐌀𐌁𐌇 *kó*, 𐌀𐌁) *ku*, 𐌀𐌁} *kú*

If there is no vowel mark, by default the vowel *a* is used: 𐌀𐌁 *ka*.

5. Syllable-final consonants are written with symbols above or to the left of the consonant-vowel block:

𐌀𐌁̇ *kak*, 𐌀𐌁̇𐌃 *kan*, 𐌀𐌁̇𐌆 *kat*, 𐌀𐌁̇𐌇 *kang*

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From <http://www.ancientscripts.com/lepcha.html>:

Basic letters with vowel = /a/:



Other vowels:



Final consonants:



Consonant clusters are also possible, but not relevant to this problem.

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Solution and marking.

Scoring (max 8)

- 2 points for each correct answer; 1 with one error (e.g. one wrong morpheme).
 - + = morpheme boundary, included for marker's convenience – not expected in answers.

4.1.	chungpemyax	They were kissed.
4.2.	pichixgal	He used to die.
4.3.	We used to kill them.	pimi+chem+chix+nin+wen.
4.4.	You (plural) stepped on us.	chimi+wix+em+in



Commentary

- Verb templates
 - template 1 (with *in* or *yax*):
 - [obj] [ROOT] [subj] [in/yax] [“used to”]
 - template 2 (no *in/yax*):
 - [obj] [subj] [ROOT] [“used to”]
- Affixes:
 - no affix = intransitive
 - *in* = transitive (“i” drops after vowel: $V_{in} \rightarrow V_n$)
 - *yax* = passive
 - *nin* = causative (a kind of transitive, means “make X [verb]”)
 - “used to”: *qal* with singular subject, *wen* with plural subject
- Pronouns
 - Subject:

▪ 1s: ne	1p: chem
▪ 2s: e	2p: em
▪ 3s: pe	3p: pem
 - Object:

▪ 1s: ni	1p: chimi
▪ 2s: i	2p: imi
▪ 3s: pi	3p: pimi (in fact, it is <i>mi</i> , but <i>pimi</i> can be inferred)
- Verbs:
 - *wix* = step on
 - *pulin* = bear a child
 - *hama* = feel shame
 - *chung* = kiss
 - *chix* = die



Solution and marking.

Scoring (max 35)

- Q3.1: 1 point for the main idea. (max 1)
- Q3.2: 1 point for the forms, one for their meanings. (max 2)
- Q3.3: 1 point for each correct single word, so 2 for some items a-o (max 22)
 - ignore item (a)
 - pay attention to ó~o, ś~s, i~y+

Q.3.1.	<i>Loafers are classified as nonhuman due to their laziness.</i>	
Q.3.2.	<i>wielkoludy (a nonhuman giant, like in a fairy tale) and wielkoludzi (a tall person)</i>	
Q.3.3.	a. kalendarze [ignore – sing = kalendarz]	i. chybcy piloci
	b. jarskie kapelusze	j. czepki
	c. łotrzy	k. grzejniki
	d. robotnicy	l. rude groby
	e. chorowici chirurdzy	m. szympansy
	f. partnerzy OR partnerzy	n. panowie
	g. zwaliści golfiści	o. załężeki
	h. zachodnioeuropejscy akordeoniści	



Commentary

- ❖ **Nouns:** the masculine nouns in Polish language can be divided into several groups:
 - nouns (no matter **persons/nonpersons**) with a soft stem (excluding the ones which end in **-c/-ca/-ec**), i.e. **-ń/-ć/-sz/-rz/-l**
=> pl. := stem + **-e**;
 - **nonpersons** with a stem which ends in **-c/-ca/-ec**
=> pl. := stem + **-e**;
 - **persons** with a stem which ends in **-c/-ca/-ec**
=> pl. := stem + **-y**;
 - **persons** with a hard stem (excluding the ones which end in **-k/-g/-r**)
=> pl. := modified (softened) stem + **-i**; (!) For the softening see below!
 - **persons** with a (hard) stem which ends in **-k/-g/-r**
=> pl. := modified (softened) stem + **-y**; (!) For the softening see below!
 - **nonpersons** with a hard stem (excluding the ones which end in **-k/-g/-r**)
=> pl. := stem + **-y**;
 - **nonpersons** with a (hard) stem which ends in **-k/-g/-r**
=> pl. := stem + **-i**;
 - nouns (for **persons**) that mean titles/ranks/positions/kinship terms
=> pl. := stem + **-owie**;
 - **persons** who are treated as **nonpersons** (darmozjad/łotr/pijak/zabójca)
=> pl. := stem + **-y**.
- ❖ **Adjectives:** they can be formed in two ways:
 - if the adjective modifies a nonperson
=> pl. := stem + **-e** or pl. := stem + **-ie** (after **-g/-k**);
 - if the adjective modifies a person
=> pl. := modified (softened) stem + **-i** or
pl. := modified (softened) stem + **-y** (after **-dz/-c/-rz**).



❖ Softening:

hard version	soft version
g	dz
k	c
r	rz
st	ść
zn	źń
t	ć
ch	ś
ł	l
sn	śń
sł	śl
zł	źl

❖ Additional rules (for the nouns):

- when a **vowel** is added to a soft stem which ends in **-ń/-ś/-ć/-ź**, the soft consonant should be replaced with its hard equivalent, i.e. **-n/-s/-c/-z** + **-i** + **the vowel**. If **the vowel** is **-i**, then the word ends in just one **-i**.
- Moving **-e**:
 - ✓ there are cases when
CeC + suffix = CC + suffix (C = consonant);
 - ✓ Ciec + suffix = Cc + suffix (C = consonant);
 - ✓ the rule above is satisfied for *szwagier* as well;
- the final **-a** which can be observed in some of the singular nouns is omitted when the plural form is formed;
- if the noun denotes a kinship term, but ends in **c/-ca/-ec**, then the rule for a person whose stem ends in **c/-ca/-ec** is used.

❖ Additional rules (for the adjectives):

the first rule from the ones stated above “*Additional rules (for the nouns)*”.

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Solution and marking.

Scoring (max 17)

- 5.1: 1 point for each correct letter (max 14)
- 5.2: 1 point for each correct translation (max 3)

5.1.	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14
	A	M	H	I	B	D	F	G	E	N	C	J	K	L
5.2.	təc			dog					cəs		feather			
	dex			top, upper part										

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Commentary

The challenge in this problem is to see semantic connections between the English translations which might motivate formal similarities in the Witsuwit'en. These connections are hinted at in the literal meanings in the middle column.

Witsuwit'en	literal meaning	English
1. bət	belly	A. abdomen, belly
5. dəlkw'aχ + dət'ay	frog + duck	B. bat (animal)
11. neɫdəc	blanket	C. blanket
6. dəlkw'aχ + neɫdəc	frog + blanket	D. broad leaf plantain
9. ɬəc + tɬ'ol	dog + rope	E. dog harness
7. dət'ay	duck	F. duck
8. dət'ay cəs	duck + feather	G. duck feather
3. dəlkw'aχ	frog	H. frog
4. dəlkw'aχ + bət	frog + belly	I. light blue
12. tɬ'oɬ	rope	J. rope
13. yəs	snow	K. snow
14. yəs + cəs	snow + feather	L. snowflake
2. bətdex	belly + top	M. upper part of stomach
10. ɬəc + yəs	dog + snow	N. wolf